



Overtourism

Can a city have too many visitors?

More people travel today than ever before. For some beautiful places, that is a problem.



Listen to the article

Scan the QR code or visit the link.



Thousands of tourists crowd the streets and beach in Positano, Italy.

WARM-UP

Talk about the questions with a partner.

1. Do you like busy places or quiet places? Why?
2. Why do tourists come to your town or city?

USEFUL LANGUAGE

I like... because...

They come to see...

In Barcelona, some people who live in the city walked through the streets with water pistols. They sprayed a little water at tourists outside the cafés. It was a kind of joke, but the message was serious: "Tourists, go home." Barcelona welcomes more than 30 million visitors a year. Many **residents** now feel that the city is not really theirs.

This problem has a name: overtourism. It happens when a place gets more visitors than it can manage. The streets become very **crowded**. Prices go up. Small **local** shops close, and new shops open for tourists. Venice, Amsterdam and Kyoto all know this feeling well.

The numbers are surprising. Fewer than 50,000 people live in Venice, but 100,000 tourists can arrive there in a single day. Now Venice asks day visitors to pay a small **fee** of five euros. Amsterdam does not allow new hotels. On Mount Everest, climbers sometimes wait in a long line near the top.

But tourism is not the enemy. It brings jobs and money, and it brings people from different countries together. Some cities want to **limit** the number of visitors. Other people say we need a better way to travel. Nobody has an easy answer yet.

Who does a city really belong to — the people who live there, or the people who visit?

VOCABULARY

A. Match the words (1–5) with the meanings (A–E).

- | | | |
|--------------|-------|--|
| 1. residents | _____ | A. money that you pay to do something |
| 2. crowded | _____ | B. the people who live in a place |
| 3. local | _____ | C. to stop something getting bigger |
| 4. fee | _____ | D. full of too many people |
| 5. limit | _____ | E. from the same town or area |

TRUE OR FALSE

Read the sentences. Circle T (True) or F (False).

- | | | |
|--|----------|----------|
| 1. Some people in Barcelona sprayed water at tourists. | T | F |
| 2. More than 100,000 people live in Venice. | T | F |
| 3. Amsterdam does not allow new hotels. | T | F |
| 4. Climbers sometimes wait in a line on Mount Everest. | T | F |
| 5. The article says tourism only brings problems. | T | F |

DISCUSSION

USEFUL LANGUAGE I think... · For me... · because... · It depends.

- 1 Have you visited a place with too many people? How did you feel?
- 2 Do many tourists come to your town or city? What do they come to see?
- 3 Why can tourists and residents feel differently about the same place?
- 4 Is it fair to ask tourists to pay a fee? Why or why not?
- 5 Who does a famous city belong to: the residents or the visitors?



01 CRITICAL THINKING

YOU ARE THE TOWN COUNCIL

40,000 people live in your town. Three million tourists visit every year.

You are the town council. Choose your rules. Every rule helps someone and it costs someone. Work in a group and choose together.

THE RULE	IT HELPS	IT COSTS	YES
Tourists pay a small fee	The town gets money to clean and repair the streets.	Tourists with little money, and the cheap hotels.	☐
Fewer big ships each day	Thousands of people do not arrive at the same time.	Tour guides and the shops next to the port.	☐
No new hotels	Visitor numbers stop growing every year.	People who want new jobs in building and in hotels.	☐
Apartments only for residents	Rents go down, so local families can stay in the town.	Neighbors who rent their rooms to tourists for more money.	☐
Change nothing	The town keeps all the jobs and all the money.	The families who leave the town, one by one.	☐

YOUR CHOICE Rules we say yes to: _____ of 5 The people who will not be happy: _____

- DISCUSS**
- 1 Your job is in a hotel. Do you choose the same rules? Why or why not?
 - 2 Compare with another group. Who helped the residents more? Who kept more jobs?

02 LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

USE THE LANGUAGE

Complete the sentences with a word from the box.

limit residents crowded fee local

- 1 The beach was very _____ in August.
- 2 Many _____ want fewer tourists in their city.
- 3 We ate dinner in a small _____ restaurant.
- 4 Visitors pay a small _____ to enter the old town.
- 5 The city wants to _____ the number of big ships.

04 WRITING

YOUR OPINION

Should tourists pay a fee to visit a popular city?

Write 60–100 words. Use words from the article.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

I think tourists should... · The first reason is... · For example,... · But... · So I think...

03 SPEAKING CHALLENGE

ROLE • TASK • PRESENT

Work in small groups. Follow the three steps.

ROLE You are the town council. Your small town is now very popular with tourists.

TASK Choose two rules for your town. Decide who pays for them.

PRESENT Tell the class your two rules and say why they are fair.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

Our first rule is... · We chose it because...
This is fair because... · We think... should pay.